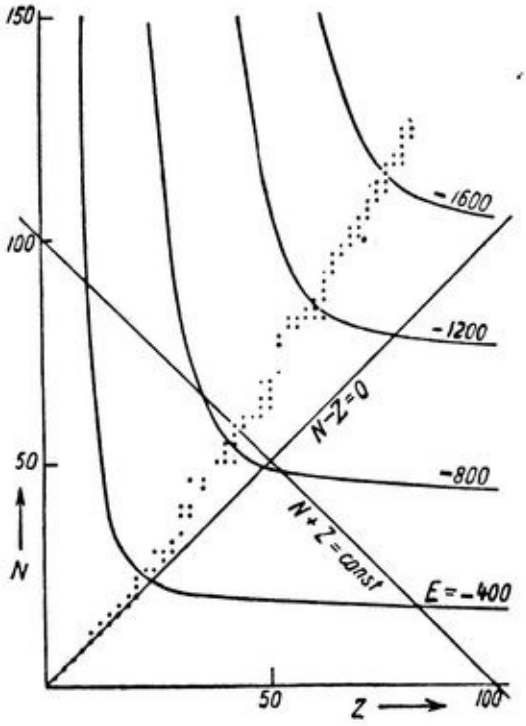


Figure 12.—Positions of the stable nuclei and curves of constant binding energy.

Figure 13 shows a picture of the situation in a different light. In this case, the combined totals of the numbers of particles, $N + Z$, appear as abscissae, and the ratios of the particles, N/Z, as ordinates. The continuous straight line corresponds to the dots along the valley floor, and the dots indicate the positions of the individual stable nuclei. We can see how they are distributed along the valley floor and in its immediate vicinity.

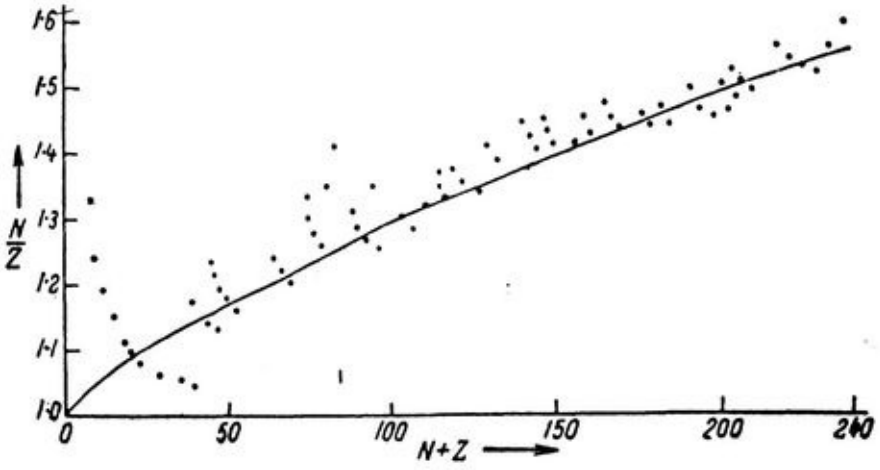


Figure 13.—N/Z as functions of $N + Z$ in the case of stable nuclei.

In Figures 11, 12 and 13, only stable nuclei are shown. The complete picture is presented by Tables IVa and IVb (at the end of the book) which include all the known unstable nuclei. The abscissae show the number of